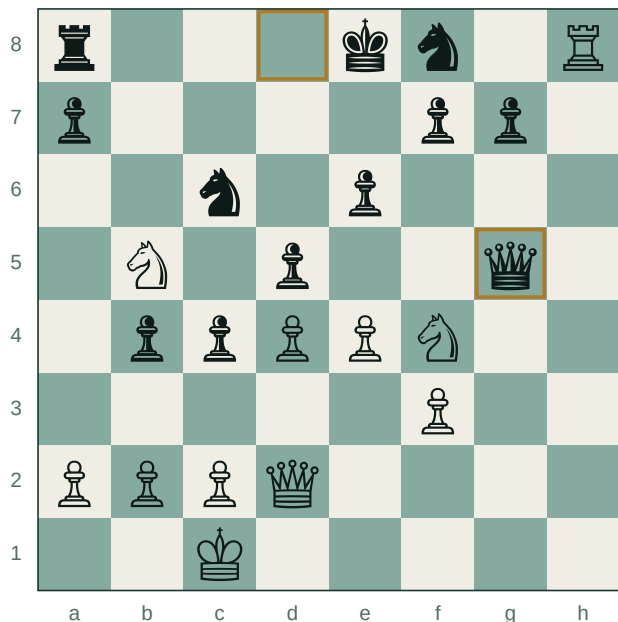


Attraction tactics: White, move 20

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 19...Qxg5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20. Rxf8+ Kxf8 21. Nxe6+ fxe6 22. Qxg5

20.Rxf8+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on f8. Recorded reply: **20...Kxf8**.

21.Nxe6+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From e6 it attacks king on f8 and queen on g5. Recorded reply: **21...fxe6**.

22.Qxg5 The queen captures the queen on g5.

At the end, nominal material is White 18 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on e8. Absolute pin: knight on f8.